SAI DARBAR MOTAR TRAINING SCHOOL

Driving School Standard Operating Procedures (SOP)

Version 1.0 | Updated November 2026 | Audience: Owner, staff and instructors

Government-authorised (RTO-recognised) motor driving school, working since 2012-13.

Purpose and scope

This document sets out the Standard Operating Procedures (SOP) that staff, instructors and the owner follow every day. It matches the school's management system: staff app and website, admin website, and customer app. Waiting periods and similar system defaults are marked as defaults; the 30-day waiting period before the driving test and the 6-month learner licence validity are set by law. Contact: phone / WhatsApp 8677097777.

1. Roles and responsibilities

Role	Main responsibilities	System access
Owner / Admin	Holds the Form 11 licence, sets rules (waiting periods, prices), manages staff, reviews reports, approves corrections and refunds, handles escalations.	Everything, including settings, staff, reports, batches and pricing.
Staff (counsellor / office)	Admission, document review, onboarding, fee entry, licence stage updates, reminders, student support, registers (Form 14, Form 15).	Onboard customers, update licence stages, own dashboard and alerts. Cannot change global rules or prices.
Instructor	Practical training, vehicle pre-check, attendance and session notes, safety.	As assigned by the owner.
Customer (student)	Provides correct documents, attends sessions, follows policy, uses the app.	Own journey, free and paid batches, practice tests, notifications.

2. SOP-01: Enquiry and admission

1. Greet the student. Ask which vehicle class they want and whether they already hold a learner licence.
2. Explain the process (learner licence, 30-day wait, training, driving test, licence delivery), the total fee, what is and is not included, the refund rules and the fact that the RTO decides the test result.
3. Share the School Policy. Get the student's questions answered before admission.
4. Check eligibility: age for the vehicle class, guardian consent if under 18, and any medical condition.
5. Collect original documents for verification. Accept only what the RTO accepts.
6. Enter the student in the school's register in Form 14 for the year, and keep the alphabetical list of students admitted (rule 27(a)).

3. SOP-02: Onboarding in the system

1. In the staff app or website, tap Add Customer.
2. Capture or upload the Aadhaar or PAN image. The system reads the text (OCR) and fills the form.
3. Review and correct every field. OCR can make mistakes. Check name, date of birth, gender, address and PAN against the original document.

4. Add mobile number, email address, vehicle class, course or package, fee, amount paid, payment mode and photograph. A valid email or mobile number is required.
5. Tick the consent box after explaining how documents and data are used.
6. Look for a duplicate warning (same mobile, PAN or learner licence number). Resolve it before saving.
7. Submit. The system creates the customer record, login account, fee record, secure document storage, and audit entry in one step.
8. The student receives an email with a set-password link that expires in 24 hours. If the student has no email, send credentials by SMS and note it.
9. Hand over the fee receipt. Confirm the student has installed the customer app.

Data rule
Never store the full Aadhaar number. Only the last 4 digits are saved. Do not photograph or forward documents on personal phones.

4. SOP-03: Fee collection and receipts

- Every payment is entered in the system the same day, with amount, date, mode and the staff member's name.
- Issue a receipt for every payment. No receipt means no payment accepted.
- Cash collected is counted and deposited regularly, as instructed by the owner. Online payments are checked against the bank or UPI statement weekly.
- Refunds, discounts and fee changes need the owner's approval and a recorded reason.
- Pending fee reminders are sent by staff using the pending-fee list, with a polite message. No threats or pressure.

5. SOP-04: Learner licence stage

1. Help the student apply on the Sarathi portal with their own details. Never ask for a government portal password or OTP, and never bypass CAPTCHA or OTP.
2. Prepare the student for the LL test using practice tests in the customer app.
3. When the LL is issued, open the LL Details block and enter: learner licence type (for example TR), enrollment number (when the type needs it), LL number and LL issue date.
4. The system automatically calculates the LL expiry date (issue date plus 6 months) and the waiting end date (issue date plus waiting days, default 30). Do not calculate these by hand.
5. Verify the issue date against the LL document. A wrong date changes every later date. Only the admin can correct it, and the correction is logged.
6. The customer's status moves to WAITING_PERIOD and the countdown appears in the customer app.

6. SOP-05: Waiting period and alerts

When	What the system does	What staff do
Day of LL entry	Starts the waiting countdown; sends a notification to the student.	Tell the student the eligible date and start the training plan.
2 to 3 days before waiting ends	Alert to staff with the list of students who become ready.	Prepare documents and call the students. Plan the test booking.
Waiting end day (day 30)	Status becomes ELIGIBLE. Email and notification to the student; alert to staff.	Book the RTO test slot through the official process and enter the appointment.
1 day after, no appointment entered	Reminder to staff on the dashboard.	Book the slot or note the reason.
15 days before LL expiry	Alert to staff.	Prioritise the test. If the LL may expire, tell the student early.

Check the dashboard widgets **Ready in 2 days** and **Ready today** every morning.

7. SOP-06: Training sessions

Before the session (instructor)

- ■ Vehicle documents available: RC, insurance, fitness, pollution certificate.
- ■ Tyres, brakes (including the instructor's dual brake), clutch, steering, lights, indicators, horn, mirrors, wipers.
- ■ Fuel level, dashboard warning lights, seat belts, door locks, 'L' sign and the school name, address and phone number on the vehicle.
- ■ First aid kit and fire extinguisher present. Vehicle clean.
- ■ Student has the learner licence and is fit to drive (not unwell, not under alcohol or drugs).

During the session

- Start in a low-traffic area. Move to busier roads only as the student gains control.
- Follow the training plan, which is based on the rule 31 syllabus: seat and mirror adjustment, steering, clutch control, gears, starting and stopping, hill start, reversing, parking, junctions, lane change, overtaking, night and rain driving.
- Give clear and calm instructions. No shouting or abuse. Always stay alert with a foot ready on the dual brake.
- The instructor sits where he or she can control or stop the vehicle, and the 'L' sign is displayed at the front and rear.
- Stop the session if it is unsafe or if the student is unfit.

After the session

- Mark attendance and record the session date, duration, topics covered and the student's progress. Enter the driving hours for the trainee in the Form 15 record (rule 27(i)).
- Report any fault, damage or incident to the manager the same day.
- Update the training plan for the next session.

8. SOP-07: Appointment (driving test) booking

1. When the student is ELIGIBLE and the training is adequate, apply for the permanent licence on Sarathi with the student, and book the test slot.

2. In the system, open the Appointment block and enter: appointment date and time, RTO name or code, and the application or reference number.
3. The student receives an email and a notification with the date, time, RTO and what to bring. Reminders go out 2 days before, 1 day before and on the morning.
4. Staff also call the student 1 day before to confirm.
5. Appointment dates are entered manually. Do not assume dates, because RTO schedules can change with holidays.

9. SOP-08: Test day

Checklist

- ■ Learner licence, original ID and address documents, application and slot receipt, photographs.
- ■ School vehicle (if provided) checked, fuelled and ready, and of the class applied for, or the student's vehicle confirmed.
- ■ Student has had a short practice on the test track route if possible, and is calm and well rested.
- ■ A staff member or instructor reaches the RTO early.
- • Be polite and follow RTO staff instructions. Do not pay or promise any unofficial money to anyone.
- • Record the result (PASS or FAIL) in the system the same day. The student is notified automatically.

10. SOP-09: After the test

If the student passes

1. Status becomes TEST_PASSED. The scrutiny or approval wait starts (default 5 days, admin-configurable).
2. When it ends, staff are alerted to enter the permanent licence details.
3. Open the DL Details block and enter the DL number, issue date and expiry date.
4. Status becomes COMPLETED. The student is notified. Mark whether the card has been dispatched or delivered.
5. Issue the driving school certificate in Form 5 to the student who has completed the course (rule 27(d)), if not already given.
6. Ask for feedback and a review. Remind the student about renewal and safe driving.

If the student fails

1. Record FAIL with remarks (for example: reverse parking, clutch control, did not check mirrors). The attempt number is saved.
2. Speak to the student kindly. Explain the mistakes and arrange extra practice.
3. Status becomes TEST_FAILED and the re-test wait starts (default 7 days). After it, the Appointment block opens again.
4. Check that the learner licence will still be valid on the new date. If it will expire, the student must start the learner licence process again.

11. SOP-10: Exceptions

Situation	Action
OCR read wrong data	Staff always review and correct before submit.
Duplicate customer	Stop. Check the existing record. Do not create a second one.
Wrong LL issue date entered	Ask the admin to correct it. The system recalculates the dates and logs who did it and why.
Waiting period must change for one student	Admin override with a written reason. The legal minimum of 30 days before the driving test cannot be shortened.
Student wants to pause or cancel	Set ON_HOLD or CANCELLED with a reason. Apply the refund rules and get the owner's approval.
Student has no email	Send credentials by SMS and record it. Email is the main channel, so try to get one.
Student has not installed the app	Email remains the guaranteed channel. Help them install the app.
A staff member leaves	Admin disables the account and reassigns their students.
LL expiring before the test	Escalate to the manager the moment the 15-day alert appears.

12. SOP-11: Vehicle maintenance and documents

- Daily pre-session check (see SOP-06). Any fault is noted and reported on the same day.
- Weekly: tyre pressure, oil and coolant level, brake and clutch feel, lights.
- Service at the intervals recommended by the manufacturer. Keep a service log.
- Keep a renewal calendar for insurance, fitness, pollution certificate and the driving school licence. Renew vehicle documents at least 15 days before the expiry date.
- A vehicle without valid documents or with an unsafe fault must not be used for training.
- Training vehicles are used exclusively for instruction, and all except motorcycles keep working dual controls (rule 24(3)(v)).

13. SOP-12: Incident and accident

1. The instructor stops the vehicle safely, switches off the engine, and turns on hazard lights.
2. Check for injuries. Call 112 or 108 for serious injury. Give only basic first aid.
3. Inform the manager and owner immediately. The owner informs the student's family.
4. Inform the police if required and the insurance company. Take photos and note vehicle details.
5. Record the incident in the incident log with date, place, people, cause, action and follow-up.
6. Review the incident and take steps to avoid repeating it.

14. SOP-13: Data and document handling

- Use only the school's system to store student documents. No copies on personal phones, WhatsApp or email.
- Paper copies are kept locked and are shredded after they are scanned and no longer needed.
- Only staff who need a document may open it. All views and edits are logged.
- Never share a student's details with anyone except the student, a parent or guardian of a minor, or a government authority as required by law.
- Report any suspected data leak or lost device to the owner at once.

15. SOP-14: Complaints

1. Listen without interrupting. Write down the complaint, date, person and what the student wants.
2. Try to resolve it on the spot if it is within your authority.
3. If not, pass it to the manager the same day. Tell the student when to expect a reply.
4. Follow the escalation path in the School Policy. Close the complaint in writing and record the outcome.

16. SOP-15: Compliance with the driving school licence

These duties come from rules 24 to 28 of the Central Motor Vehicles Rules, 1989 for the holder of a driving school licence in Form 11. The owner checks them every month.

Duty	What the school does	Rule
Valid licence	Keep the Form 11 licence valid. It lasts 5 years. File the renewal application in Form 13 with the licensing authority not less than 60 days before expiry. Do not run the school on an expired licence.	24, 25
Annual criteria check	Where the State requires an annual certification of the licence conditions, complete it on time.	25 (proviso)
Display	Display the original licence and the names and addresses of the instructors at a prominent place in the office.	27(j)
Registers	Keep the annual register in Form 14 with an alphabetical list of students admitted, and a Form 15 record of driving hours for each trainee.	27(a), 27(i)
Syllabus	Teach the course according to the syllabus, training period and driving hours in rule 31.	27(b), 31
Certificate	Issue Form 5 to every student who has completed the course.	27(d)
Vehicle marking	Show the school name, full address and telephone number in bold letters on all training vehicles.	27(h)
Premises	Do not shift the school from the premises named in the licence without the prior written approval of the licensing authority.	27(f)
Returns and inspection	Give the licensing authority the information or returns it asks for, and keep the premises, records and registers open for inspection.	27(e), 27(g)
Honest dealing	Do not mislead applicants about the ability to procure a licence, and do not connive in circumventing the rules.	27(k)
Suspension risk	Failing these conditions can lead to suspension or revocation of the licence after a hearing. An appeal lies within 30 days.	28, 29

The text of the Central Motor Vehicles Rules and any State conditions on your licence prevail over this SOP. Check morth.gov.in and the Maharashtra Transport Department for the latest notified version.

17. Daily, weekly and monthly routine

Frequency	Staff	Admin / Owner
Daily	Check Ready in 2 days and Ready today; call students; enter appointments, results and licence details; record payments; check pending results and DL entries.	Check the dashboard summary, pipeline by stage, overdue cases and missed alerts.
Weekly	Update pending-fee list; confirm next week's appointments; review the vehicle checklist.	Review staff activity, pass and fail rates, and fee collection.
Monthly	Archive closed cases; check data accuracy; check that Form 14 and Form 15 records are up to date.	Revenue and batch reports, staff performance, document and licence renewals (SOP-15), policy and SOP review.